

Skills Summary

Take-Away and Comparing Stories

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Model a Take-From Story

Rule: When things pop, fly off, or get eaten, the story is subtraction: start – taken away = left. Draw the start, cross out what goes, count what stays.

Example: 7 ducks are on the pond. 2 swim away. How many ducks are left?

Step 1. Swimming away is taking from, so we draw 7 ducks and cross out the 2 that leave.

Step 2. Count the ducks with no cross: 5. So $7 - 2 = 5$. ✓

⇒ there are **5** ducks left

Try it: 9 ants are on a log. 5 crawl away. Draw it and count how many are left.

check: 4

Skill 2 — Write the Take-Away Equation

Rule: The story numbers go into the equation in order:
start number – number that goes away = number left.

Example: 6 frogs sit on a log. 2 hop off. Write the equation and solve it.

Step 1. The start number is 6 and the go-away number is 2, so the equation is $6 - 2$.

Step 2. Count back from 6 twice: 5, 4. ✓

⇒ $6 - 2 = 4$

Try it: 8 birds are on a wire. 3 fly away. Write the equation and solve it.

check: 5

Skill 3 — Compare by Matching

Rule: “How many more?” means match the two groups one to one. The unmatched extras are the answer — and subtraction counts them: bigger – smaller = how many more.

Example: Ria has 8 shells. Dev has 5 shells. How many more does Ria have?

Step 1. Comparing means matching: each of Dev’s 5 shells pairs with one of Ria’s, and the extras answer the question.

Step 2. $8 - 5 = 3$ shells have no partner. ✓

⇒ Ria has **3** more shells

Try it: One team has 6 balls, the other has 2. How many more does the first team have?

check: 4

(!) Watch out: “How many *fewer*?” and “how many *more*?” use the same subtraction! Both count the unmatched extras — so $9 - 6 = 3$ answers both questions about 9 and 6.